

DR. SAMANEH KHAEF

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I am a Human geographer with extensive teaching experience across Bachelor's and Master's courses in human geography, GIS, spatial analysis, migration, and research methods, as well as experience supervising students at both levels (592 hours of teaching since 2018). My research focuses on migration and integration, education and labour-market pathways, residential mobility, housing and neighbourhoods, with particular attention to regional and geographical inequalities and how spatial and urban-rural contexts shape life-course trajectories and integration outcomes.

CURRENT POSITION

2024–present — Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Human Geography, Stockholm University

Current projects:

- Embedded Lives: Contextual Effects on Life Course Trajectories (2026–2029)
- Language and Life-Course: An Exploration of the Swedish-for-Immigrants Program, 1990–2022 (2024–2027)
- How Do Perceptions of the City Inform Neighbourhood Selection and Housing Search? A Comparison of Second-Generation Migrants and Natives in Uppsala (2023–2026)

Completed project:

- The Neighbourhood Revisited: Spatial Polarization and Social Cohesion in Contemporary Sweden (2019–2024)

EDUCATION

2024 — PhD, Human Geography, Stockholm University

- Thesis: Migration Trajectories and Education: Measurement, Spatial Patterns, and Integration Pathways of Adult Migrants

<https://su.diva-portal.org/smash/get/diva2:1842515/FULLTEXT01.pdf>

2013 — MSc, Urban Planning and Management (with application of GIS), University of Twente, Netherlands

- Thesis: Examining Quality of Life through a Gendered Lens in Birmingham

2011 — MSc, Urban and Regional Planning, University of Tehran, Iran — with great distinction

- Thesis: Exploring Dimensions of Quality of Life in a Deteriorated Neighbourhood in Tehran Metropolitan City

2009 — Bachelor of Urban Studies, University of Tehran, Iran — with great distinction

- Final project: Assessing Smart Growth Indicators in Planning Development, Tehran

RESEARCH INTERESTS & METHODS

- Migration, education, labour-market integration, residential choice and mobility
- Neighbourhoods, housing, segregation, spatial polarization and social cohesion
- Integration across generations and across the urban-rural hierarchy
- Kinship, social ties, neighbourhood mobility and residential pathways
- School and preschool segregation and educational pathways
- Gender, migration and geographical context
- Quantitative methods, semi-structured interviews and social surveying
- Swedish register data; Stata, SPSS, R/RStudio, Microsoft Excel and ArcGIS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2024–present — Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Human Geography, Stockholm University

2018–2024 — PhD Student, Department of Human Geography, Stockholm University

2017 — Visiting Scientist, Migration, Demography and Security Unit, European Commission Joint Research Centre, Ispra, Italy

- Project: School and residential segregation in Italian metropolitan areas.

2014–2017 — Senior Planner, Arse Planning Consultancy Firm, Tehran, Iran

- Neighbourhood composition and school segregation across municipalities in Tehran.
- Mapping inequality: spatial variation in school demographics and socioeconomic composition.
- Multiculturalism, migration and ethnic diversity.
- Housing-market discrimination against Afghan migrants in Iran.

2013–2014 — Senior Planner, Parhoss Urban Planning Consultancy Office, Tehran, Iran

- Educational inequalities and school accessibility in deprived neighbourhoods.
- Integrated planning for an inclusive society in southern Iran.
- Segregation and fragmented development in Tehran metropolitan area.

2009–2011 — Junior Planner, Design, Architecture, Environment, Urban Planning Consultancy Company, Tehran, Iran

2008–2009 — Planner Assistant, Novinsaz Kelar Architecture and Planning Company, Tehran, Iran

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS & DISSERTATION

Khaef, S., (2026). Enrolment and patterns of participation in Swedish for immigrants (SFI): timing, duration, and selectivity. *Genus*, 82, 11, <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41118-026-00288-1>

Khaef, S., (2025). Unravelling integration: Educational enrolment pathways of adult refugees in Sweden. *Population*, 80 (2), <https://doi.org/10.3917/popu.2502.0153>

Khaef, S., (2024a). Migration Trajectories and Education: Measurement, Spatial Patterns, and Integration Pathways of Adult Migrants. Stockholm University, Faculty of Social Sciences, Department of Human Geography. ORCID iD: 0000-0002-2270-9729

Khaef, S., Haandrikman, K. (2024b). The Initial Residential Patterns of Immigrants Across the Urban Hierarchy in Sweden: The Role of Educational Attainment. *Tijdschrift Voor Economische En Sociale Geografie*, <https://doi.org/10.1111/tesg.12608>

Khaef, S., (2022). Registration of Immigrants' Educational Attainment in Sweden: An Analysis of Sources and Time to Registration. *Genus* 78, 16 (2022). <https://doi.org/10.1186/s41118-022-00159-5>

Khaef, S., Zebardast, E. (2016). Assessing Quality of Life Dimensions in Deteriorated Inner Areas: A case from Javadieh Neighbourhood in Tehran Metropolis. *Social Indicator Research*. 127, 761–775. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11205-015-0986-6>

Khaef, S. (2013). Perception of quality of life through a gendered lens. a case from the city of Birmingham. University of Twente, Faculty of Geo-Information Science and Earth

WORKING & UNDER-REVISION PAPERS

Khaef, S., (2026a). Uneven returns to language training participation: regional variation in migrants' first employment entry in Sweden

Khaef, S., Malmberg, B. (2026b). Life-Course Trajectories and Tenure Type Contexts: Spatial Assimilation among Migrants in Sweden

Khaef, S., (2026c). Family ties and neighbourhood attainment: kin proximity, kin's neighbourhood poverty, and residential mobility in Sweden

- Forsberg, S., **Khaef, S.**, (2026d). Residential reasoning and stigmatisation: How place labels and perceived unsafety shape housing search
- Wimark, T., **Khaef, S.**, Frisch, F. (2026e). From Private to Corporate: Privatisation and financialization in the Swedish housing market. Under revision

POLICY BRIEF and DISCUSSION

- Khaef, S.** (2026). "Uneven employment benefits of language training: regional variation in migrants' first employment entry in Sweden". Population Europé. [Population Europe – Policy Insight](#)
- Khaef, S.** (2025). "Sweden's migration rules 'not really in favor of those with high education", Interviewed by Local Sweden based on my expertise on migration, high education. Link to interview: [Read the interview at The Local](#)
- Khaef, S.** (2025). "Utbildningens betydelse för invandrades integrationsprocess". Magasinet Konkret. [Read the article at Magasinet Konkret](#)
- Khaef, S.**, Migali, S. (2017). The relationship between immigrants' location in Italian cities and schools, JRC, European Commission, internally published
- Khaef, S.** (2016). Gendered Perspective in Planning and Development, Ministry of Road and Urban Development

RESEARCH FUNDING & GRANTS

- 2025 — Vetenskapsrådet: Embedded Lives: Contextual Effects on Life Course Trajectories — SEK 6,627,591. PI: Bo Malmberg; co-applicants: Samaneh Khaef, Linn Axelsson and Jutta Kawalerowicz.
- 2024 — Vetenskapsrådet: Språk och livsbana: Svenska för invandrare som inkörsport, 1990–2022 (2024–2027) — SEK 6,754,724. PI: Bo Malmberg; co-applicants: Samaneh Khaef, Linn Axelsson and Katrin Ahlgren.
- 2022 — Hur påverkar uppfattningar om staden valet av bostadsområde och sökandet av en bostad? — SEK 6,721,356. PI: Sara Forsberg; co-applicants: Samaneh Khaef, Guilherme Chihaya Da Silva, Benjamin Jarvis.
- 2019 — Alice Wallenbergs: publication and conference participation support.
- 2020 — Carl Mannerfelt Fond: publication and conference participation support.
- 2022–2023 — Universitetets Donationsstipendier: publication and conference participation support.
- 2023–2024 — Ahlmanns Fond: publication and conference participation support.
- 2023–2024 — Lagrelius Fond: publication and conference participation support.
- 2011 — Erasmus Mundus, SALAM scheme: tuition, accommodation, travel and monthly allowance.

TEACHING

2018–2026 — Teaching at Stockholm University

• Undergraduate:

GIS and Spatial Analysis I;
 Essay on Swedish Geography;
 Swedish Geography; Geographical Methods I;
 Geographical Information Systems and Cartography;
 Geography II;
 Intelligence Analysis for Policy and Business (Human Geography);
 Geographical Information Analysis II;
 Place, Identity and Migration.

• Postgraduate:

Migration and Social Change – A Life Course Perspective;
 Advanced Method in Human Geography and Urban and Regional Planning.

SUPERVISION

Master students (successfully completed):

- 2026 Suleman Swala–Integration of migrants to labour market and role of SFI
2026 Märtha Eriksson–Honor Norms and Social Control in Urban Environments in Stockholm
2024 Tramosljanin, Vanja– The role of language in social and cultural dimensions of integration.

Bachelor Students: 2018_2026 (successfully completed):

- Hibah Rabto– Hur långt är för långt till parken?
Emma Woxborg Cederborg–Tillgång och tillgänglighet till samhällsnödvändiga verksamheter i Strängnäs kommu
Björn, Nordvall– An Autoethnographic Reading of Urban Habit and Memory
Elin, Mattsson–Polycentricity as A Sustainable Spatial Structure?
Julia, Nordenvall–Utmaningar I Barndeltagandet: När Går Ribban Från Att Vara Målsnöre Till Snubbeltråd?
Matilda, Karlsson–Analys Om Hantering Av Översvämningsrisk I Planeringsarbetet: En Kvalitativ Fallstudie På Karlstads Kommun
Philip, Brunzell Hessling–Resenärers Val Av Tåg Till Och Frånflygplatsen

CONFERENCES & ACADEMIC ENGAGEMENT

- 2026: International Geographical Union; Nordic Geography Meeting; European Population Conference; International Geographical Union / Royal Geographical Society.
- 2025: Beyond the Registry, Beyond Academia; IMISCOE 22nd Annual Conference; ECSR–Collegio Carlo Alberto–NASP Spring School of Integration Across Generations; Nordregio knowledge sharing.
- 2024: European Association of Population Studies, Edinburgh.
- 2023: Uppdrag landsbygd, Uppsala; Applied Population Geography Research, Lesbos; Stockholm University Demography Unit; EpiDem PhD Conference, Torekov.
- 2022: European Network for Housing Research, Barcelona.
- 2019–2020: Population Geography Conference, Loughborough; Stockholm University Demography Unit; Research Group Studies on Education, Migration and Segregation (EMS), Uppsala University.
- 2018: European Network for Housing Research, Athens.
- 2024: Guest expert, workshop “Archives as tools for integration and belonging”, Stockholm.

ACADEMIC SERVICE & MEMBERSHIPS

- 2026: Invited participant in EU Horizon project We-ID (Identities – Migration – Democracy), University of Göttingen.
- 2025–present: Affiliated member, Centre for Migration and Integration Research, Stockholm School of Economics.
- 2025–present: Member, Housing, Education, Segregation (BUS), Uppsala University.
- 2025–present: Key member, Education and Social Inequality Standing Committee, IMISCOE.
- 2024–present: PhD Representative in Supervision Meetings.
- 2023: Representative of Social Sciences Faculty Council to the Central PhD Student Council, CDR.
- 2022: Secretary, PhD Council Meeting.
- 2019–present: Key member, IILME Standing Committee, IMISCOE.
- 2018–2020: PhD Representative, ALM (Work Environment, Gender Equality and Equal Conditions), Human Geography Department.
- 2018: Event organizer, Pink Programming.

PEER REVIEW

Cities;
Emotion, Space, and Society;
Educational Research Review;
Comparative Migration Studies;
Humanities & Social Sciences Communications;
Journal of International Migration and Integration;
Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies;
British Journal of Sociology;
Journal of Housing and the Built Environment.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & LANGUAGES

- 2024 — Professional Development 1: Teaching and Learning, 7.5 ECTS, Centre for the Advancement of University Teaching, Stockholm University.
- Pedagogical workshops: Strategies for successful supervision; Exploring AI text generation for teaching and learning; Encouraging student engagement through interactive lectures.
- 2018–2024 — Swedish Language Courses for International Employees, Stockholm University / Folkuniversitetet: Swedish A–D.
- 2023 — Svenska som andraspråk, grundläggande delkurs 2, ABF City, 200 points.
- 2021 — Swedish language private tuition, 15 hours.

REFEREES

• **Professor Bo Malmberg:** Professor of Human Geography, Stockholm University | bo.malmberg@humangeo.su.se | +46 08-16 48 53

PI of two ongoing projects, main PhD supervisor;

• **Associate senior lecturer, Sara Forsberg:** Human Geography, Uppsala University | sara.forsberg@kultgeog.uu.se | +46 70 425 03 56

PI of one ongoing project, co-applicant in my VR application

• **Associate Professor, Thomas Wimarck:** Human Geography, Uppsala University | thomas.wimarck@kultgeog.uu.se | +46 18 471 73 77

Colleague on “Neighborhood revisited” project, co-authoring a paper under revision

• **Professor Pieter Bevelander,** Professor of Human Geography, Malmö University | pieter.bevelander@mau.se | 040-665 73 43

My PhD opponent.

Co-applicant on a project proposal previously submitted to RJ, together with me and other collaborators; the project is currently under development.